WEIRD
LIBRARY-SCIENCE
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APPROVED BY THE ZINE CODE AUTHORITY

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An actual, serious letter from the editor

As you may or may not have noticed, this issue of Two-Fisted Library Stories is all content created by one person (me). This is due to the lack of contributions I received for this issue from people that weren't cisgendered men.

For the last few issues I've strived to feature diverse characters in the cover art, but after releasing the 8th issue (a satirical academic journal called Two-Fisted Library Studies) last month, I realized that this diversity is not reflected in the creators inside the zine.

As far as I can tell, the vast majority of contributors to the past two issues have been cisgendered men (for something library related, that's terrible!), and across every issue released so far I have (I believe) only one contribution from someone who isn't caucasian.

For this issue I only received contributions from cisgendered men (five of them!), despite several deadline extensions and individual invitations.

That isn't the sort of contributor list I want to publish in an anthology about libraries, so I informed contributors that their content would be put on hold until I had enough content from a more balanced set of creators.

If you are a person of colour or identify as a woman or non-binary person and are interested in doing something please let me know! Your contribution can be as big or small as you like.

You could create comics, serialized fiction, profiles of fictional librarians, fake one sentence issue blurbs for non-existent publications, fictional fan letters that discuss stories that never happened, book related horoscopes, and lots more. Feel free to look at back issues on our website (twofistedstories.blogspot.com) to get an idea of the sort of things that are published.

Contributors retain all rights to their work, can use pseudonyms, and if they would prefer their work to only show up in the physical version (and not online) they just have to let me know.

Contributors only get paid in free copies of the issue they're published in (honestly, I lose money making these things), but if you're interested in drawing a cover I'm willing to pay you something.

If you have any questions or want to discuss anything, please send me an email at twofistedstories@gmail.com.

Thanks,
Matthew

A vastly more important letter from the over-editor

Foolish Earthlings! Can you not hear it? It is your **ANNIHILATION**! If you do not heed my warning Earth and all those you hold dear will soon **CEASE** to **EXIST**.

In order to prevent the coming **CATACLYSM** you must **SUBMIT** to the next issue of Two-Fisted Library Stories!

The fate of your very planet relies on you creating enough **GLOW** (Galactic Library Oriented Wisdom) Power to defeat the evil **BEIGE** (Book-Eating, Information-Grinding Entities) or else your very presence in the galaxy will be **ANNIHILATED**.

How do you create **GLOW** Power? You must use your **TOWERING** imagination to create the most **ACTION-PACKED** stories, comics, drawings, photographs, recipes, knitting patterns, phony letters, fake news items, bogus advertisements, made-up issue blurbs, and whatever else you can think of as long as it is filled with **THRILLS**, **EXCITEMENT**, and **LIBRARIES**. Mad science, weird fantasy, occult horror, spicy mysteries, noirish romances, intense adventures, and whatever else.

Stories can be about librarians, library technicians, library cats, sentient libraries, etc. Write about a a cataloguing system so obtuse that it drives those that try to use it **INSANE**, a library that uses **BIZARRE ALIEN TECHNOLOGY**, or a library worker who has to track down an **EVIL** zeppelin in order to get an **OVERDUE BOOK**. As long as your contribution is somewhat library focused and filled with the requisite **GLOW** Power it's fine!

So get out your typewriters, crayons, and drawing sticks (or whatever it is you Earthlings create with) and create something or the Earth you call home is **DOOMED**!

More info is available at twofistedstories.blogspot.com.

Submissions can be sent to twofistedstories@gmail.com.

Submit by August 31st or face **EXTINCTION**.

Jeong-Hyo Pak, Astrobrarian of the 27th Century
in

The Intergalactic Book Smugglers

Chapter One: Catalogue Chaos

Jeong-hyo Pak sat at her desk working on a particularly difficult reference question when a green-skinned patron approached the desk and chittered at her.

"CHKCHKCHKCHKCHK."

"Excuse me one moment Mx. Tu!x--an," said Jeong-hyo, recognizing one of her regular patrons. Pronouncing the name still caused her some trouble (she didn't think she'd ever manage to roll her x's properly), but the patrons always appreciated the effort. "Just let me switch over my translator."

The Mark XVI translators were brand new to the library, and some of the other staff were complaining about using them. Jeong-hyo couldn't understand how they'd managed to use the Mark IX's for so long, especially since the software hadn't been supported in years. The new ones still weren't perfect by any stretch of the imagination (you were limited to one language at a time, and even then the translation could be... problematic), but they made professional (and non-professional) interactions with patrons considerably easier.

"CHKCHKCHou could help one find a resource." The translator clicked to the correct language (Ic'aVr'an) as Jeong-hyo smiled and nodded.

"Of course 'Tiz*', what are you looking for?"

"One is looking for the Tasič Quine. Any opuscule."

Jeong-hyo entered the request into her computer and pulled up the results.

"I'm sorry, it looks like none of the opuscules are available right now. Would you like me to put one on hold for you?"

** Short for Citizen†. Official library policy insisted that the full version be used in all patron interactions, but since everything went through the translators Jeong-hyo wasn't sure how much it really mattered.*
† For those worrying about non-citizens getting service, don't! The Celestial State have ruled that all sentient species are citizens, regardless of their planet or place of origin!

“One has been on hold for several lunar cycles,” stated Tu!x--an, clearly upset.

“Just let me take a look and I’ll see what we can do.” Jeong-hyo opened up another window and began checking the details on the item in question. She noted that the item was listed as “in transit”, but something seemed off to her. “That doesn’t seem right,” she thought, when she saw that Mx. Tu!x--an had in fact been on hold for quite some time, despite there being nobody else in line for the items in question.

Digging deeper into the data Jeong-hyo found that the date when the items had first gone into transit was several years before. “Wait, all of them went into transit on the same day and disappeared?” she thought, checking the other opuscules on her list. How had nobody noticed this?

Wanting to look into this further, but realizing she still had a patron to deal with, she quickly looked up the digistore. “Our physical copies are all currently unavailable, but I’m authorized to purchase a digital copy of the first opuscule for you while we try to figure this problem out.” Jeong-hyo once again thanked her recent upgrade to Librarian Rank ∑, which allowed her greater independence in ordering material for patrons.

Tu!x--an’s tendrils wove through the air haphazardly as they exhaled. “One supposes that would be better than nothing,” they said, clearly disappointed.

“Great, just let me get your library card number and I’ll get everything started.” Jeong-hyo completed the rest of her interaction with the patron efficiently, but in the back of her mind knew this was something she was going to have to look into.

✱ ✱ ✱

“Art thou coming to the bar for libations after work?” Dak asked Jeong-hyo through their translators.

“Not tonight, not feeling great.”

“Well, hopefully we’ll see thou on the morrow!”

Jeong-hyo watched as Dak slithered out of the room, and returned to the report she’d been working on all day. This was it, the months spent researching had finally paid off. The report that she’d spent hours creating listed page after page of library items designated as “in

transit", which was not in itself an uncommon thing in a library system with several thousand branches. However, there were dozens, no, hundreds of items which had been listed as "in transit" for several lunar cycles or, in some cases, multiple full solar orbits! Somehow this was the one system designator that didn't generate any sort of alert.

She pulled up a document listing items seized in the most recent ILO* sting. These were items that were suspected to be coming from libraries, but had apparently been through a chop shop that had erased any reference to their original point of origin.

Almost every item on the list matched one on her report of items that had gone missing from her library .

Jeong-hyo took a swig from the bottle of Galkathian En7l liquor, coughing as she swallowed. Then she brought up El, her shift supervisor and placed a call.

*Cough*cough*cough*

"Jeong-hyo? Are you alright?" El asked, concern clearly in their voice.

'Thing I'bve come down wib sobeting," Jeong-hyo replied, wishing she didn't have to lie to El who, she was sure, had nothing to do with what she was investigating. "I'b not goin' to geb in tomoddow."

"Aiieee, that is... not a problem… I'm sure we can find someone to cover your shift. Feel better." El disconnected, and Jeong-hyo knew they were already running through the list of on-call librarians. She hated to do this to El, but she was afraid if she didn't investigate this now she might not get another chance.

She opened the safe and looked at the contents. She had library cards from half a dozen different systems, in dozens of names. She carefully selected one that she knew was clean and, just in case she needed to update her info when she visited the library, matched it to a valid ID card that included an address (phony of course).

The rest of her disguise was easy. She stepped into the remodulator, and her outfit was disassembled and reassembled around her. She kept it fairly simple, though she doubted even her coworkers would recognize

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* *Intergalactic Library Organization*

her. She'd gone undercover as other species before, but something about the appropriation had made her deeply uncomfortable, and she avoided it if at all possible.

Checking the hallway outside her room to make sure none of her neighbours were there, Jeong-hyo slipped out the back way through her sector. She walked ten minutes to the nearest shuttle stop, renting a garishly coloured vacuum suit on her way. She hoped she wouldn't need it, but experience had showed her that it always paid to be prepared.

The public shuttle showed up a few minutes later (they tended to be on time in this sector, though at busy times two or more might fly past with "Sorry, full" written on their sides before one would finally stop). Right now Jeong-hyo was heading against the traffic, and so the shuttle was half empty and she was able to grab a seat. She hated those long shuttle rides when you ended up standing, packed between the other passengers.

She busied herself running through the blueprints of the branch she was heading to while keeping an eye on the other passengers. It never hurt to be paranoid in her field.

Before too long the shuttle pulled up near the library branch and Jeong-hyo pulled herself out of her seat.

"Urgh," she thought. "Low gravity." She'd forgotten that this station was at a lower gravity that she was used to. And while she appreciated that when she was helping patrons with heavier items, right now she knew her movements would mark her as an outsider. Briefly she considered aborting the mission until later, but she knew she had to forge ahead.

She entered the building and approached the reference desk. "Excuse me, I have a question..."

"Hello there," the being responded in perfect Galactic Standard. "I'm Glllrggl Glqs, how may I help you?"

✱ ✱ ✱

She led Glqs down to an isolated area she had scoped out previously. "So where was the item?" Glqs said, looking around. Before they could realize that her reference question had been a ruse she pushed her stunner against their body and frowned as the library worker crumpled to the floor. She didn't usually

like resorting to violence, but the new stunner she been equipped with was terribly effective. She quickly bound the body of the library worker, stripped them of their ID, and pulled them under some furniture that she hoped would hide them well enough for now*.

"At least the low gravity is working to my advantage now," she thought as she pushed the last appendages out of sight.

She wasn't sure how long she'd have until the missing library worker would be discovered, but she hoped she'd have at least twenty minutes.

Jeong-hyo made her way out the front door of the library, before quickly turning and heading right back to the employee entrance. The door scanned her card, then she replayed the audio she'd recorded when the library worker had introduced themselves, and used the print and retinal moulds she'd made to bypass the final security systems.

"No wonder these libraries keep getting robbed," she thought to herself. "Our security systems are hopelessly outdated."

She walked back towards the ILL** department and froze. There was Valkyr Glossy, second-in-command of the Renegade Masters of Library Science and Jeong-hyo's greatest enemy, and they were eating all of the books. This wan't covered in library school!

End part one.

What will Jeong-hyo do? How did Valkyr Glossy escape from the Data Hole? Just how much nutrional value do books have? Find out next month!

** How will Glllrggl Glqs, Saturnian LibTech explain this one? Find out in Megagalactic Library Funnies #67, on sale next month!*
*** Interstellar Library Loan*

THE DINOBRARIAN ROARS AGAIN

"Leaping lizards! That dinosaur is a librarian!"

With those words we were first introduced to Elloisa Raptoropoulous in *The Witch's Library* #19 released 65 years ago in an issue cover-dated May/June 1953. At the time nobody realized that a hastily added background character would prove to be so enduringly popular. In fact, the character was a last minute addition to an old jungle adventure story after editor Wilhelmina Losse realized that she was short a library-related story for the issue and had an artist quickly draw a book cart in front of a dinosaur and add a few speech balloons. At the time, fans were outraged about a jungle adventure story appearing in the horror themed *The Witch's Library* title; who knows how they would have reacted if Losse hadn't made those changes!

It was only a few months later when, with issue #23, the decision was made to merge *The Witch's Library* with *Weird Applied-Science* and renamed to *Weird Library-Science* the title you are familiar with today. While the initial experiment did not prove to be successful (the title was renamed again to *Incredible Library Studies* with issues #30 before being cancelled with issue #33) the quality of the stories has meant that the title has never been far from our hearts.

Elloisa would return in issue #24 of *Weird Library-Science*, though this time at least she was meant to be in the story from the beginning! Hoping to find some way to deal with the large foreign corporation that was causing harm to the local community* the unnamed hero in the story is able to send a reference question through a sonar network of bats to Elloisa (forseeing the internet based ready reference service used by many libraries today!) who quickly replies with the relevant labour laws which are swiftly used by the union and the local court system to force the corporation to vastly improve working conditions. Victory!

** The "jungle" location in this story is never named and the poor art and odd colouring of the characters is such that it is ambiguous as to which continent this story even happened on.*

This would become Elloisa's usual modus operandi for the next decade as she appeared in various titles and acted as a sort of information ingénue, offering her reference services by distance to any who contacted her. The character was portrayed as shy and fearful of letting anyone too close to her lest they become aware that she was *gasp* a dinosaur!*

This all came to a head in *Library Showcase* #45 (1963) when the modern incarnation of the Dinobrarian really began to evolve. In this issue's lead story ("The Jungle Librarians and the Legendary Lost Computer Laboratory") Elloisa, as usual, answers a seemingly innocent reference question. However, after being visited by the Jungle Librarians she discovers that she had provided this information to the Interlibrary Loan Sharks who had used it to commit a crime! After teaming up, Elloisa and the Jungle Librarians quickly brought the Loan Sharks to justice.

Soon, letters came pouring in praising this new, active version of Elloisa and this support led to her gaining her own backup strip that ran from the double-sized issue #50 (1964) until the final issue of *Library Showcase* (#93 in 1970). This backup strip was the first time that the name "Dinobrarian" had been used in relation to this character**. Strangely, Elloisa was never called this within the stories themselves! The quality of these backup stories varied, and today they are best known for introducing the character who would become Elloisa's long term nemesis: Biblio-Bruja (and her Bibliogoblins).

With the end of *Library Showcase* Elloisa's character went into hibernation for almost a decade. In fact, it wasn't until 1978's *Library Team-Up* #70 ("When Walks the Living Library!") that we saw her again! That issue, a

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** To be perfectly honest the character was mostly used by lazy writers who had written themselves into a corner and needed an easy out. A typical example appeared in the final issue of Incredible Library Studies when Baroness Książka was locked in a tower prison cell by The Infomagician. The Baroness submitted a reference question regarding lock picking to Elloisa who quickly responded allowing the Baroness to escape.*

*** An unrelated Dinobrarian had briefly appeared, and died, in several of the "Library that Time Forgot" stories appearing Star Spangled Library Stories in the late 1940s.*

team-up with title star The Shelver, featured a number of firsts: the first time Elloisa was referred to as the Dinobrarian in the comic itself and her first time on a cover! Yes, remarkably the character had gone 25 years before appearing on a cover!

Throughout the 1980s the Dinobrarian appeared in various titles, much as she had in the 1950s. However, this time she took a much more active role in dealing with ne'er-do-wells. She also became a supporting character for issues #113 - #146 of *The Stupendous Shelver*. These appearances proved popular enough for several one shots (*Dinobrarian vs. The Libarbarian* and *Dinobrarian vs. The Libearian*) to be released in 1986, though no ongoing series appeared, due in no small part to the collapse of the market for Archives related titles having a spillover effect on the entire industry.

By the 1990s most paleontologists had agreed that dinosaurs were feathered and the original Dinobrarian design seemed woefully out of date. It was decided that for the 40th anniversary of the character in 1993 something needed to be done to update the character for the then upcoming new millenium. Thus what seemed, at the time, a fantastic idea: Introducing a new Dinobrarian from a parallel dimension who better fit the feathered dinosaur ideal. This happened in the now classic *Classification Conundrum Caper* crossover where the original Dinobrarian died while attempting to answer a complex reference question, and the new, extreme, feathered version first appeared, rolling up on a skateboard.

For some unknown reason, the speculator market seized upon this first appearance (in *Classification Conundrum Caper* #4) as important and first printings sold for foolishly large prices. Striking while the iron was hot, a new series was soon released. *The Delightful Dinobrarian* angered old fans and new as the Dinobrarian spent their time helping patrons with technology problems instead of reference questions. Debates raged in the letters column for the entirety of the 75 issue run, with both sides having their supporters and detractors. The series was a minor hit, due in no small part to the holographic and glow in the dark covers used on several issues, but was never a true bestseller. Despite lasting for over six

years, *The Delightful Dinobrarian* did little to truly develop the character (now going by the name "Ellie"). The revolving lineup of creators seemed to have a hard time getting a good grasp on the character and tended to focus more on introducing new technologies than creating a supporting cast (the main exception being CD-Ron, who managed to fulfil both aspects).

The early 2000s featured another of the periodic lulls in the "library fiction" market, with the audience instead moving over to other titles such as *Book Shop Detective*. However, as with most fads (such as the boom and collapse of Archives-related titles of the late 1980s), this soon came to an end and libraries were once more at the forefront of people's wantlists.

There were occasional appearances by the Dinobrarian during this time, but the further into the past the 1990s moved the more embarrassing the "extreme" version of the character became. Thankfully, we've finally figured out a way to make Elloisa work again and, hopefully, please all previous fans of the character.

We don't want to give too much away, but the story does involve the 5th dimensional research tesseract that's been popping up over the last year and you may want to go back and read the death of the original Dinobrarian soon. Remember, no body was ever found...

The new Dinobrarian design (seen on the cover of this issue!) is not necessarily scientifically accurate (in fact, far from it!) but we feel it features elements of the two previous versions and combines them into something we think looks great! Let us know what you think and for the full story don't forget to check out *Library Fine Wars* #1, out next month!

Patron Records

Look, I'm sick of the argument that the character of Glllrggl Glqs, Saturnian LibTech, is demeaning to Library Technicians. Glqs is not just good at their job, but receives ample support from their colleagues (as evidenced by the many classified staff awards displayed on their desk)! Yes, they are always getting into ridiculous situations (the recent story where they got locked inside a book return had me in stitches), but it is never their fault and, by the end of every story, both the patrons and Glqs' supervisor are satisfied with how everything turned out. The laughs come from the situation, not the idea that Glqs is incompetent. *Megagalactic Library Funnies* is a humour comic, so let it be funny!

Agitated in Arcturus

We couldn't agree more!

I'm as excited about *Library Fine Wars* as any other card-carrying Legendary Library fanatic, but I have to take issue with the promotional material. The claim that Hypatia Lorde, Library Scientist, would support library fines is ruining the character. Bill B. O'Tecke? Sure, he's always been kind of behind the times, but Hypatia is one of the most progressive library characters that you publish, and the idea that she would support a regressive policy that harms those at risk the most is ludicrous. Have you totally lost touch with those actually working in libraries? I never thought I'd hope for an evil twin or a robot duplicate, but anything would be better than what you're currently doing.

Vexed in Vegas

We know we've screwed up before (we will probably never be able to apologise enough for the Circulation Invasion crossover fiasco), but this time we're asking you to read the comic before you complain. Not everything is as it seems in the Legendary Library Laboratory!

Next Month

The Circulation Crustacean and the Lavender Librarian try to solve the mystery of the Wicked Weeder. SERIALS Team 7 battle overpriced journal subscription fees. And Library Lass must face her greatest fear: All of her holds coming in at once!

STRIFE IN THE STACKS!

The Final Fight of Luchadora Bibliotecaria, the Masked Librarian

The ring seemed to dominate the front lobby of the library. Bibliotecaria walked past it every day on the way to her office, proud to know that her championship reign had brought her library respect and funding, but today it seemed different. It loomed larger in her mind than it had since that first time she'd entered the ring as a librarian decades ago*.

It wasn't that she knew she had a match coming up—at least once a week she was in there taking care of someone who didn't return their books on time or a particularly insistent library vendor—it was that she was scared. Bibliotecaria hadn't been scared in a long time. She'd defended her title dozens of times but she knew her time was coming to an end.

She was getting old. Heck, she was old! She'd been considering retiring for years. She could train other librarians, do some commentary, volunteer with one of the "friends of" groups. But it had never seemed like the right time and now it might be too late. She'd let her opponent goad her into a "No DQ" title match and she was afraid she was going to pay the price.

The Censorious Scoundrel was a recent arrival to the World Library Wrestling Championship, but they had quickly gained a following despite, or because of, their violent persona. They had earned their title shot by winning the Battlelogue event the previous month after tearing through the other entrants—The Melwey Devil, the Boolean Hooligan, the "Liar" siblings (Barrie and Brian), and Jakka Demikos—as though they didn't even have accredited master's degrees**.

★ ★ ★

The crowd exploded with cheers of "Bib-li-oh" as she entered the ring. For a moment she forgot what was on the line and just let the noise and the energy roll over her. Then she turned and saw the Censorious Scoundrel sneering at them from the

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** In the now classic Intergalactic Library Wrestling #57.*

*** Check out last month's Battlelogue limited series for the full story.*

opposite corner and remembered their oddly specific promise to rid the library of all the books about magic, queer teenagers, and peer reviewed medical publications. This was going to be a tough fight, but one she had to win.

The bell rang and the two contestants circled each other uneasily. Looking for a moment of weakness when they could strike. Bibliotecaria blinked first, and she quickly found the Scoundrel raining blows down upon her.

She fell to the mat and rolled to the side just in time to avoid a dangerous book stomp. Pulling herself to her feet using the ropes in a corner of the ring she wondered if she really could do this. "You are Luchadora Bibliotecaria," she told herself. "The best library wrestler around. The best!". She turned to face her opponent and managed, just, to duck under the kick coming for her head. Reacting without truly thinking Bibliotecaria reached back and grabbed the leg that had just missed her. The Scoundrel was caught off balance and she realized she had a chance.

She pulled The Scoundrel to the mat and used her signature ILLegal submission hold* on the leg she still held. Bibliotecaria was an expert in holds. She had used holds in every library she'd ever worked at. Nobody in the library had a more thorough knowledge of how to use holds than she did.

Yet The Scoundrel refused to tap out. The pain was evident on their face as they clawed their way to the ropes and, using them for leverage, managed to free themselves from Bibliotecaria's hold. The two rivals rose to their feet and stared at each other, ready for the next round.

Twenty minutes later things were still going strong and the area around the ring was a mess. Announcer tables were broken, bookcases had been knocked over leaving piles of books lying everywhere, and neither of the book carts was in usable shape. It was chaos.

Both fighters were battered and bruised and one of them was going to fall soon. Nobody knew who would win it all, but it looked like the Scoundrel might have finally gotten the upper hand. While they had distracted the ref, the Boolean Hooligan had

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** No longer banned since the 2017 rule update.*

snuck down to the ring and smashed a bookshelf over Bibliotecaria's back as the crowd booed loudly.

The Censorious Scoundrel climbed to the top of the corner ropes while a dazed Bibliotecaria staggered around the centre of the ring.

The crowd went silent.

"Oh my god!" screamed Inti Stutional sitting behind the commentary booth. "The Censorious Scoundrel is about to use their finishing move: The Spine Breaker! Biblio is going to be literally torn apart"

They leapt from the top rope slamming both knees into Bibliotecaria's back. She fell to the floor and lay still.

"Good God, almighty. Good God, almighty; that killed her," cried Stutional. " As God as my witness, she is broken in half!"

The Scoundrel quickly flipped around and pinned Bibliotecaria to the mat.

"One!" the crowd roared. "Two!" The referee slammed his hand onto the mat. "Thr—" Bibliotecaria kicked out of the pin, lifting her shoulders from the mat. She was safe. For now.

The Scoundrel came in for an arm bar, but Biblio countered and knocked the Scoundrel's legs out from beneath them, causing them to fall to the mat heavily. Bibliotecaria saw her chance, pulling together all of her remaining energy she scaled the ropes and threw herself through the air into her finishing move: the Flying Book Drop. Her body slammed into the Scoundrel and she quickly moved to pin them to the cheers of the crown.

"One."

The referee began their count.

"Two."

Could this be it?

"Three."

The roar of excitement as patrons in the library began to go crazy was deafening. Biblio barely even heard the ringing of the bell to indicate the match was over as she staggered to her feet. Blood streamed from a cut above her left eye.

The referee grabbed her hand, lifting it above his head to indicate she had won. The championship belt, her championship belt, was thrust into her hand and she raised it high for all to see.

“The winner, and still Heavyweight Interlibrary Wrestling Champion," the announcer roared. “Bib-li-oooooooooo!”

Somehow the patrons got even louder than before. Nobody was going to shush them now.

The Scoundrel still lay on the mat, shocked at what had happened, as Bibliotecaria took her belt and slowly began making her way back to the staff area.

This fight had taken everything she had and she had barely won. There would be more, and greater, challengers, but she wouldn’t be there to face them. She would have to have confidence in the next generation of library staff to keep fighting, but she knew they would.

Bibliotecaria returned to her office for one final time. She took one last look around, gathered up a few of her possessions, closed the door, and didn’t look back. She would retire a champion.

This may be the end of Bibliotecaria's time in the ring, but it's not the end of World Library Wrestling Federation. Come back next month for more exciting stories featuring a new group of library wrestlers who will include some familiar, and unexpected, faces.

REFERENCE REPORTS

Item! Z39.50 has travelled to Hell and back in her attempts to search and retrieve information, but is it time for her to pass the torch? Find out in the GIANT-SIZED 100th issue spectacular out next month.

Item! Sides have been drawn, battles have been fought, but it all comes down to this. It's friend versus friend over the future of fines in the library. Which side are you on? Find out in *Library Fine Wars* #0. One of the biggest stories ever in Library Laboratory history!

Item! You may have seen that we recently did very well in the Borges Awards! In addition to the "Favourite Portrayal of Libraries" award we received for the "Libraries are Not Neutral" storyline in *Action Librarians*, we also picked up "Best Non-Human Librarian" (The Libearian) and *Spicy Library Stories* won some awards we can't print here. Make sure to vote in this year's awards!

Item! For the latest in library adventure tales, don't forget to follow us on our Twitter! @2fistedstories

Item! Missing an issue? Remember to check out twofistedstories.bigcartel.com where you can can buy all of our previous issues!

The Legendary Library Lineup!

☐ **Action Librarians #161**
The Library Legion battle the demonic Media Pirates in the ghostly study space.

☐ **Sanctimonius Shelver #18**
The book drop is haunted? Not again!

☐ **Library Fine Wars #0**
The Battle Begins! Don't miss out on this brand new story that will change everything.

☐ **Library SuspenStories #55**
Paige Paisley, Library Page, in search of the Legendary Lost Library.

☐ **Six-Gun Librarian #53**
Feud with The Dewey Decimator in 574.526! Plus: The Catalogue Kid tries to track down Ms. [illegible] in order to correct a catalogue record!

☐ **Library Team-Up, vol. 3, #6**
The Headless Librarian and the Liabrarian alone against the sexist open access journal.

☐ **LibTechs in Love #29**
Can Collette reveal their feelings for Myr the gloomy libtech?

☐ **The Midnight Library #142**
Does the Absent-Minded Archivist dare to enter the Archive of the Underworld?

☐ **Hypatia Lorde #34**
If there are predatory publishers, than who are the prey? Hypatia won't like the answer!

☐ **Z39.50 #99**
One issue 'til one hundred! The Cybrarian battles Z39.50 in the imaginary institutional repository. Will anyone survive the experience?

Borges Libraries in Fiction Awards

It's time make your voices heard and vote in the 2018 Borges fan-awards for best portrayal of libraries and library workers in fiction! You can mail in your ballot, send your answers to twofistedstories@gmail.com, or complete it online at http://bit.ly/borgesawards. The deadline is September 30th, 2018.

Favourite Portrayal of Libraries
☐ Satan's Shelvers #1
☐ L-Day #6: Imposter Syndrome
☐ The entire "Budget Crisis" crossover
☐ _____

Best Use of Technology
☐ Any time CD-Ron shows up
☐ The Six-Gun Librarian shoots someone (a gun is technology right?)
☐ The Library Legion get the catalogue back online
☐ _____

Worst Forking Path
☐ Linear Library Stories #3
☐ Knife and Spoon Library Tales #18
☐ Strange Science Library #42: The Sole Route to Working in a Library
☐ _____

Worst Conundrum
☐ Hypatia Lorde travels to a dimension in which the capital of the USA is in Washington state
☐ LibTechs in Love features non-libtechs not in love
☐ The Libearian becomes their own boss
☐ _____

Best Labyrinth
☐ Frontline Librarian #13: Finding Your First Library Job After Graduation
☐ The Library of Fear #8: The Terrible Automated Online Hiring System
☐ Giacomo Casanova's Library of Love #21: I Have No Idea How My Predecessor Organized This Place
☐ _____

Favourite Non-linear Moment
☐ Hypatia Lorde, Library Scientist returns a book before she borrows it
☐ Any time the Midnight Librarian goes out in the daytime
☐ The Perilous Patron insists on paying the replacement fee before they check out a DVD they don't plan on returning
☐ _____

Best Non-Human Library Staff Member
☐ Gllrggl Glqs, Saturnian LibTech
☐ Samira Squirrel, Branch Librarian
☐ Uncanny Val, Library AIssistant
☐ _____

Least Contradictory "Paradox"
☐ The Phantom Librarian dies and becomes a ghost or something???
☐ The Anarchivist reveals they don't have a Master's in Archival Studies
☐ The Masked Librarian discovers library staff aren't diverse because they don't hire diverse employees
☐ _____

Ongoing Series You Forgot Existed (on purpose)
☐ The Library Guide to Eastern Antarctic Government Documents
☐ Super Cool Library Crew
☐ The Librarian-Replacement Volunteers
☐ _____

Least-Favourite Character
☐ Either of the Jungle Librarians
☐ Dinobrarian (II)
☐ The LiBROrian (does anyone like this guy???)
☐ _____

Favourite One Shot or Miniseries
☐ Luchador Bibliotecario vs. the Boolean Hooligan
☐ Hypatia Lorde and the Underworld Archive
☐ Libtechs in Love: Left at the Checkout Counter
☐ _____

Greatest Moment
☐ The Astrobrarian finally tracks down Queen Satan's overdue library books
☐ Library Lass vs. the Renegade Masters of Library Science
☐ The Sci-brarian convinces a faculty member to upload something to the Institutional Repository
☐ _____

Portrait of a Young Librarian

07-09

It has been ten months since I completed my studies in library science, and I still have yet to hear back positively from any of the positions I applied for. I fear if I do not receive word from one of them by the end of the month I will have to return to my parents' estate in L—. A fate that I am not looking forward to as they have disapproved of my education at every step.

07-16

Still no word from my most recent applications. It has done little to improve my mood over the last few months to see my former classmates getting hired and heading off to start working in libraries. Yesterday I saw G—, generally accepted to be the class dullard, who told me they had just gotten a position at F— University. I'm not sure what else was said, because I spent the rest of the conversation in a daze. I quickly headed home and drowned myself in drink. G—! Of all people. Surely I am better than them.

But no, the ever growing pile of rejections sitting on my desk indicates that apparently I am not. I have informed my landlady that I will be moving out at the end of the month. I do not want to, but I cannot afford to live here any longer. My quickly dwindling funds will not even afford me to become an alcoholic, which would at least lessen the emotional toll this process is having upon me.

07-23

I have sent a letter to mother that I shall be returning home soon. It is not what I had wanted, but, alas, it is all I can do. I realized yesterday that with the success of G— in finding employment, I am now the sole student from my classes who remains in town. All others have gained employment or returned to their families.

On the positive side of things, I have managed to stay merrily drunk more often than I had expected. Chiefly this has been due to pawning the majority of my belongings. It shall, at least, make it easier for me to pack for my trip home.

07-30

I had packed my few remaining clothes and books into my bags, and was biding

my landlady farewell, when there was a knock at the door. Upon answering there was a messenger who had a letter for me. At first I was loath to even open it, having received so many rejections in the past, but my landlady, who is of a far more positive demeanour than myself, encouraged me to do so.

Inside was written something I had given up all hope of ever seeing.

"Dear S—,
We are writing to inform you of an offer to work as Librarian at V— University. The position begins as soon as you can arrive. Lodging is provided."

To be quite honest, I did not remember there even being a university in V—, let alone applying for the position. Yet, at the time that did not even enter my mind. A job! Truly, this was a remarkable day!

As I was already packed, I rushed to the coach-house and exchanged my ticket for one going to V—, and happily one was heading in that direction that very day! What followed was a long and uncomfortable journey in a variety of increasingly rickety coaches and wagons. While I was aware that V— was not an especially developed district, it had not occurred to me that this would also apply to the transit that would take me there.

Still, I arrived after just a few days, and was greeted by the Chancellor of the school, a surprisingly round and jolly person. They were very happy to see me, though it seemed that little could happen to dull their mood. They gave me a brief tour of the campus, and showed me to my lodging, where I now write this. Thankfully, meals are provided for faculty here, as I have not a guilder left on me after my journey.

08-06
This is a most... peculiar place. While the buildings of the college are very old, it appears as though the school itself is brand new. There are but a handful of faculty, and barely more students in attendance.

I asked the Chancellor regarding this, and also, in a roundabout manner, how I had gotten hired in the first place. Regarding the former they said that students and faculty were on their way, and that things would surely begin to pick up during the summer months. As for the latter, they apologised profusely saying that they were unaware of the details

surrounding my hiring, and would be unable to find the out. Apparently the previous administrator in this area had caught ill and died just before my arrival, and at the same time a fire had managed to set fire to all of the records and correspondence of the school. The Chancellor didn't seem bothered by this at all, and ensured me that I looked extraordinarily qualified to act as the head librarian. This would have sounded more complimentary if I had not also heard them state in the past week that:

- The other faculty were extraordinarily qualified
- The dining hall staff were extraordinarily polite (they were not)
- The food was extraordinarily delicious (it was not)
- The weather was extraordinarily good (as it had been pouring rain the entire week I decided to ensure I never travel to wherever the Chancellor is from)
- A particular type of beetle they had found was extraordinarily qualified (at what they did not say)

I almost fear to know what would be considered ordinary or unqualified by the Chancellor.

The library itself is a disaster. Just room after room of boxes filled with papers and books and who knows what else. While I initially spent some of my first day trying to make sense of the material I had available to me, I have spent most of the past week moving boxes around and arguing with local carpenters about how to install shelving.

08-13

I know I am still early in my career, but I feel I must be working with the least competent contractors ever. I ask them to do one thing and somehow they do three things that all seem to be the complete opposite! Our shelves are a disaster, with some not straight and others seemingly designed for books that are triangular or other shapes! Similarly, our tables and desks might as well not exist for all the use they seem as though they may have. Perhaps I am not cut out to be a library manager.

The Chancellor is always willing to hear my complaints and have discussions with me and while I leave them feeling generally positive I soon realize that not a thing was actually agreed upon on or planned.

I continue attempting to sort through the boxes of books, though now at least I have been assigned an assistant.

They seem quiet, though have yet to really do much either. Maybe that is for the best as my attempts to interact with other staff and faculty on campus have been… less than satisfactory at best and actively terrifying at worst. (I will not be approaching the Geography department again any time soon).

08-20

A curious thing happened this week. My assistant Jean uncovered a stack of boxes that included a plethora of books in strange and interesting shapes. Somehow they all seem to fit perfectly onto the oddly shaped bookshelves the contractors had built. Did they know about these books? If so, why did nobody tell me! Perhaps their peculiar furniture also has a use that I have yet to discover.

I know that I am a city child at heart, but I had thought that by this time I would be more used to the rural setting in which this university is set. Alas, I spend half my nights unable to sleep due to the many noises I can hear from outside. The screeches and yowls are so unsettling that I would swear that something unnatural was happening, but nobody else has ever mentioned it and so I must assume that it is just a creature I am unfamiliar with.

08-27

Boxes and boxes and boxes! Every time Jean and I think we have finally managed to unpack all of the books, we find not just another box, but an entire room filled with boxes! Where did they come from? How did they even get here?

To add to that, many of the books are in languages and alphabets I do not understand, which has led to difficulties in creating a catalogue.

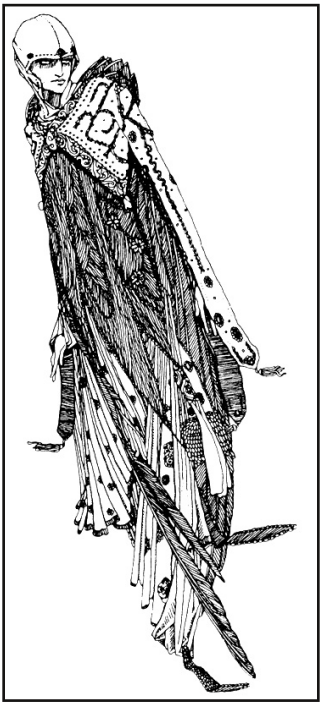
Class begins next week and the stress seems to be affecting my ability to process time. A faculty member came to ask for a title this morning and while I thought I was only gone for a few minutes when I came out of the stacks it was dark. Similarly Jean seems to appear and disappear seemingly at random. They are generally helpful, though I wonder if I would get more done if I didn't spend so much time trying to find them.

09-03

The students have started arriving, the semester starts tomorrow, and still we are not ready. I am a wreck.

[Next: Classes begin!]

CONTRIBUTORS



After angering the space kobolds, **Matthew Murray** was forced to haunt a featureless desert constructed to cause him to question every value he has ever held dear. His every moment is a constant struggle to survive and stay sane, but mostly he just posts on Twitter @MidniteLibrary.

Image Inspiration and Credits

The wrestling poster on the back cover is heavily inspired by "WWE Wrestlemania XXXI Poster (Vintage Style)" by RicGrayDesign

The poster also uses "Old paper 5" by Snowys-stock as a background.

The cover image is traced/redrawn from a composite of other images.

- Main dinosaur: "Velociraptor" by Vitor-Silva
- Book cart: "Library Book Cart" by SteveLambert
- Flying dino: "Eudimorphodon flying prehistoric reptile" by Leonello Calvetti
- Orange dino: A photo of Gund Baby Crom Dinosaur on Amazon (we own one, it is great)
- Book: "Closed Book Clip Art" by Tim van de Vall
- Volcano: "Karymsky volcano" by Alexander Belousov and "Volcán de Colima in central Mexico" by Hernando Rivera
- Plants: "One Palm tree cycas revoluta" by Madllen

The illustration on this page is by Harry Clarke and comes from "The year's at the spring; an anthology of recent poetry" (1920), accessed through archive.org.

THE WORLD LIBRARY WRESTLING FEDERATION PRESENTS

STRIFE IN THE STACKS!

SATURDAY, APRIL 14th, 2018 AT PUBLIK SPACE

HEAVYWEIGHT INTERLIBRARY CHAMPIONSHIP

THE MASKED LIBRARIAN
LUCHADORA BIBLIOTECARIA
★ ★ ★ (DEFENDING CHAMPION) ★ ★ ★

VS

THE
CENSORIOUS SCOUNDREL
★ ★ ★ (CHALLENGER) ★ ★ ★

IN A FALLS COUNT ANYWHERE NO DQ MATCH FOR THE TITLE BELT

CATALOGUING CHAMPIONSHIP
THE HIGH FLYING
RDAERIALIST
VERSUS
AACRTOUCAN
(LOSER RETIRES MATCH)

GRID CITY MAYHEM!
THE BOOLEAN HOOLIGAN
VERSUS
"DOC" NEWMAN TAYSHUN
VERSUS
THE DEWEY DECIMATOR
(LAST PERSON STANDING MATCH)

NON-STOP IMPACT
★ ★ ★ ★ FACTOR ★ ★ ★ ★
KATHERINE A. LOGGEUR
VERSUS
JAKKA DEMIKOS
IN A
TENURE ON A POLE MATCH